

DIPOLE TYPE BY LENGTH

STEP 0 <i>l</i> = antenna rod length (m); <i>c</i> = 3 × 10 ⁸ m/s		
λ (wavelength) = $\frac{c}{f} = \frac{3 \times 10^8}{f}$ (m)		
<i>l</i> /λ	Type	Use formula
< 1/50	Hertzian (short)	HERTZIAN <i>S</i> (<i>R</i> , θ), <i>D</i> = 1.5
= 1/4	Quarter-wave	ARB formula, π <i>l</i> /λ = π/4
= 1/2	Half-wave	half-wave shortcut, <i>D</i> = 1.64, <i>R</i> _{rad} = 73 Ω
= 1	Full-wave	ARB, <i>D</i> = 2.41, <i>R</i> _{rad} = 199 Ω
other	Arbitrary	ARB formula

HERTZIAN DIPOLE — *S*(*R*, θ)

Far-field E,H phasors <i>small l</i> ≪ λ	
$\vec{E}_\theta = \frac{jI_0 k l \eta_0}{4\pi R} e^{-jkR} \sin \theta$	$\vec{H}_\phi = \vec{E}_\theta / \eta_0$
Power density <i>l</i> /λ < 1/50; <i>far field</i>	
$S(R, \theta) = S_{\max} \sin^2 \theta$ (W/m ²)	
$S_{\max} = \frac{\eta_0 k^2 I_0^2 l^2}{32 \pi^2 R^2}$ (W/m ²)	
<i>l</i> : rod length (m)	<i>I</i> ₀ : peak current (A)
<i>R</i> : obs. distance (m)	θ: angle from dipole axis (rad)
<i>k</i> = 2π/λ (rad/m)	η ₀ = 120π ≈ 377 Ω
<i>S</i> _{max} : max pwr density (W/m ²)	
Max @ broadside ⊥ to dipole axis = equator plane θ _{max} = π/2; <i>D</i> exact <i>D</i> = 1.5 (1.76 dB)	
Total radiated power $P_{\text{rad}} = \frac{\eta_0 \pi}{3} (I_0 l / \lambda)^2$ (W)	

ARBITRARY-LENGTH DIPOLE — *S*(θ)

Power density at <i>R</i> any <i>l</i>	
$S(\theta) = \frac{15 I_0^2}{\pi R^2} \left[\frac{\cos\left(\frac{\pi \lambda}{\lambda} \cos \theta\right) - \cos\left(\frac{\pi \lambda}{\lambda}\right)}{\sin \theta} \right]^2$	
At θ = 0, π: bracket is 0/0. L'Hôpital ⇒ <i>S</i> = 0 (no axial radiation). TI-36X Pro alt: evaluate bracket at θ = 0.001 rad → tiny → 0.	
Normalized pattern dimensionless <i>F</i> (θ) = <i>S</i> (θ)/ <i>S</i> _{max}	

COMMON ANGLES (deg ↔ rad, trig values)

Conversion multiply by π/180 or 180/π						
θ _{rad} = θ _{deg} · $\frac{\pi}{180}$		θ _{deg} = θ _{rad} · $\frac{180}{\pi}$				
°	rad	sin θ	cos θ	sin ² θ	cos ² θ	
0	0	0	1	0	1	
30	π/6	1/2	√3/2	1/4	3/4	
45	π/4	√2/2	√2/2	1/2	1/2	
60	π/3	√3/2	1/2	3/4	1/4	
90	π/2	1	0	1	0	
180	π	0	−1	0	1	

Antenna formulas usually take θ in rad. RAD mode on calc.

LINEAR ANTENNA ARRAY

<i>N</i> identical elements along axis, spacing <i>d</i> , equal phase (broadside, θ _{max} = π/2). Total pattern <i>S</i> = <i>S</i> _e · <i>F</i> _a (<i>S</i> _e = single elem).	
Array factor (uniform, broadside) <i>k</i> = 2π/λ, γ = <i>k d</i> cos θ	
$F_a(\theta) = \frac{\sin^2(N\gamma/2)}{\sin^2(\gamma/2)}$; $F_a^{\max} = N^2$ at θ = π/2	
Normalize $F_a^{\text{norm}} = F_a / N^2$	
HPBW (broadside, uniform) use <i>N d</i> , not (<i>N</i> − 1) <i>d</i>	
$\beta \approx 0.88 \frac{\lambda}{N d}$ (rad) = 50.8° · $\frac{\lambda}{N d}$	
Grating lobes appear if <i>d</i> > λ. Avoid.	

DIPOLE

<i>l</i> — antenna length (m)
λ = <i>c</i> / <i>f</i> (m); <i>c</i> = 3 × 10 ⁸ m/s
<i>I</i> ₀ — peak current (A)
<i>k</i> = 2π/λ (rad/m)
<i>R</i> — obs. dist. (m); θ from axis
η ₀ = 120π ≈ 377 Ω
<i>S</i> (<i>R</i> , θ) — pwr density (W/m ²)

BEAM

<i>F</i> (θ) = <i>S</i> / <i>S</i> _{max} (unitless)
<i>a</i> — coef. on θ ² in Gaussian
<i>I</i> ₀ — HPBW (rad or °)
Ω _p — pattern solid angle (sr)
<i>D</i> = 4π / Ω _p — directivity
ξ rad. eff.; <i>G</i> = ξ <i>D</i>
<i>D</i> _{dB} = 10 log ₁₀ <i>D</i> ; <i>D</i> = 10 ^{<i>D</i>_{dB}/10}

BEAM PARAMETERS — β, Ω_p, *D*

Normalize <i>always start here</i>		
$F(\theta) = S(\theta) / S_{\max}$ (unitless)		
Beamwidth β at threshold <i>X</i>		
Set <i>F</i> (θ _X) = <i>X</i> , solve for θ _X ; β = 2θ _X (symmetric)		
Threshold	<i>X</i> = 10 dB/10	θ _X (Gauss. short-cut)
HPBW (−3 dB)	0.5	$\sqrt{\frac{\ln 2}{a}}$
−6 dB	0.25	$\sqrt{\frac{\ln 4}{a}}$
−10 dB	0.1	$\sqrt{\frac{\ln 10}{a}}$
any <i>F</i> (θ _X)	any <i>X</i>	$F(\theta_X) = X$
Pattern solid angle Ω _p recognize pattern, look up		
$\Omega_p = \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^\pi F(\theta) \sin \theta d\theta d\phi$ (sr)		
No φ dep.: Ω _p = 2π ∫ ₀ ^π <i>F</i> (θ) sin θ <i>d</i> θ.		
θ is the integration variable — DON'T plug in a number for θ (e.g. θ _{1/2}). Integrate over θ ∈ [0, π].		
Pattern <i>F</i> (θ)	Ω _p (sr)	
Isotropic (<i>F</i> = 1)	4π ≈ 12.57	
Hertzian sin ² θ	8π/3 ≈ 8.38	
Half-wave dipole	≈ 7.66	
Narrow Gauss <i>e</i> − <i>a</i> θ ²	π / <i>a</i> = πθ _{1/2} ² / ln 2	
2-axis HPBW (aperture)	β _{xz} · β _{yz}	
Other (use integral)	numerical	

TI-36X Pro: [2nd] [d/dx] for $\int_{\square}^{\square}$, RAD mode, multiply by 2π.

Directivity <i>D</i> always <i>D</i> = 4π / Ω _p ; common shortcuts below	
$D = \frac{4\pi}{\Omega_p}$ (unitless)	<i>D</i> _{dB} = 10 log ₁₀ <i>D</i>
WORD TRAP: “direction” = θ _{max} (rad); “directivity” = <i>D</i> (unitless).	
Dipoles → COMMON DIPOLE PARAMS table. Aperture: <i>D</i> ≈ 4π <i>A</i> _p / λ ² . 2-axis HPBW: <i>D</i> ≈ 4π / (β _{xz} β _{yz}). Circular: <i>D</i> ≈ 4π / β ² .	
Gain (if asked) ξ = rad. eff., 0 < ξ ≤ 1	
<i>G</i> = ξ <i>D</i>	<i>G</i> _{dB} = 10 log ₁₀ <i>G</i>
Lossless / ideal antenna → <i>G</i> = <i>D</i> .	

COMMON DIPOLE PARAMETERS

Lossless (ξ = 1): <i>G</i> = <i>D</i> .				
Type	<i>l</i>	<i>D</i>	<i>D</i> _{dB}	<i>R</i> _{rad} (Ω)
Isotropic	N/A	1	0	—
Hertzian	< λ/50	1.5	1.76	80π ² (<i>l</i> /λ) ²
Half-wave	λ/2	1.64	2.15	73.2
Monopole	λ/4 (gnd)	1.64	2.15	36.6
Full-wave	λ	2.41	3.82	199

Half-wave: *P*_{rad} = 36.6 *I*₀² *W*. Monopole (λ/4 above ground): same patt. as half-wave but *P*_{rad}, *R*_{rad} halved.

ANTENNA AREAS (*A*_e, *A*_p)

Effective area antenna's RX cross section; <i>D</i> from BEAM PARAMS or table above	
$A_e = \frac{\lambda^2 D}{4\pi}$ (m ²)	
Physical cross section wire dipole, diameter <i>d</i> ; <i>l</i> see table above	
<i>A</i> _p = <i>l d</i> (m ² , any dipole)	
Inverse: <i>D</i> from <i>A</i> _e	
$D = \frac{4\pi A_e}{\lambda^2}$ (unitless)	
Thin wire: <i>A</i> _e ≫ <i>A</i> _p (e.g., Hertzian <i>A</i> _e = 3λ ² /8π ≈ 0.119λ ²).	

FRIIS TRANSMISSION FORMULA

For each antenna's *G*: if given by NAME (“half-wave dipole” etc.) → COMMON DIPOLE PARAMS (*G* = *D*, lossless). Else (dB/linear value given) → use as given (convert dB → linear).

Pwr density at RX, then RX pwr *G*_t, *G*_r linear gains; λ = *c* / *f*

$$S_r = \frac{G_t P_t}{4\pi R^2} \text{ (W/m}^2\text{); } \left[P_r = G_t G_r \left(\frac{\lambda}{4\pi R} \right)^2 P_t \right] \text{ (W)}$$

Equivalent: *P*_r = *S*_r *A*_{e,r}.

Solve for *R* max range

$$R = \frac{\lambda}{4\pi} \sqrt{\frac{G_t G_r P_t}{P_r}} \text{ (m)}$$

Equivalent form using *A*_e recv. area form

$$P_r = \frac{G_t P_t A_{e,r}}{4\pi R^2}, \quad G_r = \frac{4\pi A_{e,r}}{\lambda^2}$$

Free-space path loss: *L*_{fs} = (4π*R*/λ)², so *P*_r = *G*_t *G*_r *P*_t / *L*_{fs}.

Off-axis (patterns not aligned): multiply by *F*_t(θ_t, φ_t) *F*_r(θ_r, φ_r), both = 1 when aligned.

Recipe 1. λ = *c* / *f*. 2. Convert any dB gain → linear: *G* = 10^{*G*_{dB}/10}.

3. Get *G*_t, *G*_r by antenna type: dipole → COMMON DIPOLE PARAMS; aperture → APERTURE box; arbitrary *F* → BEAM PARAMS. 4. Plug into Friis.

Use linear *G*, not dB. Convert FIRST.

dB ↔ LINEAR

Works for any power-like quantity (*G*, *D*, *P*_r / *P*_t, *SNR*, ...):

$X_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} X_{\text{lin}}$		$X_{\text{lin}} = 10^{X_{\text{dB}}/10}$	
dB	linear	dB	linear
0	1	10	10
3	2	13	20
6	4	20	100
7	5	30	1000
−3	0.5	−10	0.1

Memorize: 3 dB ⇔ ×2, 10 dB ⇔ ×10. Add dB = multiply linear.

For *E*-field / amplitude use 20 log not 10 log (power ∝ *E*²).

NOISE & SNR

Noise power thermal noise into matched receiver	
$P_N = k_B T_{\text{sys}} B$ (W)	
<i>k</i> _B = 1.38 × 10 ^{−23} J/K; <i>T</i> _{sys} system noise temp (K); <i>B</i> receiver bandwidth (Hz).	
Signal-to-noise ratio	
$\text{SNR} = \frac{P_{\text{rec}}}{P_N}$ (unitless) $\text{SNR}_{\text{dB}} = 10 \log_{10} \frac{P_{\text{rec}}}{P_N}$	
Typical comm. link needs SNR > 10 dB for usable signal.	

APERTURE ANTENNAS (horn, dish)

*A*_p physical aperture area (m²); *A*_e effective area (m², = λ² *D* / 4π); β_{xz}, β_{yz} HPBW's in two planes (rad); *ℓ*, *d* aperture side / diameter (m).

Directivity (any shape, uniform illum.)

$$D \approx \frac{4\pi A_p}{\lambda^2} \text{ (unitless)} \Rightarrow A_e \approx A_p$$

Directivity from beamwidths any aperture

$$D \approx \frac{4\pi}{\beta_{xz} \beta_{yz}} \text{ (use rad); circular: } D \approx 4\pi / \beta^2$$

HPBW and <i>D</i> by aperture shape uniform illum.; β in rad			
Shape	<i>A</i> _p	HPBW (rad)	<i>D</i> (unitless)
Rect. ℓ _x × ℓ _y	ℓ _x ℓ _y	β _x ≈ 0.88λ / ℓ _x β _y ≈ 0.88λ / ℓ _y	$D \approx 4\pi / (\beta_x \beta_y)$ $= 4\pi \ell_x \ell_y / \lambda^2$
Square ℓ	ℓ ²	β ≈ 0.88λ / ℓ	$D \approx 4\pi / \beta^2 = 4\pi \ell^2 / \lambda^2$
Circular (diam. <i>d</i>)	π <i>d</i> ² / 4	β ≈ 1.02λ / <i>d</i>	$D \approx 4\pi / \beta^2 = \pi^2 d^2 / \lambda^2$

Scaling (any ratio) *D* ∝ *A*_p / λ²; β ∝ λ / √*A*_p

$$D_{\text{new}} = D_{\text{old}} \cdot \frac{A_{p,\text{new}}}{A_{p,\text{old}}} \cdot \left(\frac{f_{\text{new}}}{f_{\text{old}}} \right)^2$$

$$\beta_{\text{new}} = \beta_{\text{old}} \cdot \sqrt{\frac{A_{p,\text{old}}}{A_{p,\text{new}}}} \cdot \frac{f_{\text{old}}}{f_{\text{new}}}$$

If a parameter is unchanged, its ratio = 1. Examples: double area → *D* × 2, β × 1/√2; double freq → *D* × 4, β × 1/2.

FRIIS / dB

<i>P</i> _t — power transmitted (W)
<i>P</i> _r — power received (W)
<i>G</i> _t — transmit gain (linear)
<i>G</i> _r — receive gain (linear)
<i>S</i> _r = <i>G</i> _t <i>P</i> _t / (4π <i>R</i> ²) (W/m ²)
<i>P</i> _r = <i>G</i> _t <i>G</i> _r (λ / 4π <i>R</i>) ² <i>P</i> _t
<i>G</i> = 10 ^{<i>G</i>_{dB}/10}
3 dB = ×2, 10 dB = ×10
<i>P</i> _N = <i>k</i> _B <i>T</i> _{sys} <i>B</i> (W)

APERTURE

<i>A</i> _p — physical area (m ²)
<i>A</i> _e = λ ² <i>D</i> / (4π) (m ²)
<i>A</i> _e ≈ <i>A</i> _p for aperture
<i>D</i> ≈ 4π <i>A</i> _p / λ ² (unitless)
β ≈ 0.88λ / ℓ (rect/sq.)
β ≈ 1.02λ / <i>d</i> (circular)
2 <i>A</i> _p ⇒ 2 <i>D</i> , β / √2

ARRAY

<i>N</i> — number of elements
<i>d</i> — spacing (m)
γ = <i>k d</i> cos θ
<i>F</i> _a = sin ² (<i>N</i> γ/2) / sin ² (γ/2)
<i>F</i> _a ^{max} = <i>N</i> ² at θ = π/2
<i>F</i> _a ^{norm} = <i>F</i> _a / <i>N</i> ²
β ≈ 0.88λ / (<i>N d</i>) (broadside)